

Breaking Without Entering

Access denied

The Digital Environment

Most TL4 or higher planets will rely to some degree on computers. An internet-like global network may or may not exist depending on political and cultural values but most organizations and buildings will at least have some kind of data storage and local network

Executing a Hack

Most hacking requires a physical interface with the system either by **tapping a line** with a *metatool* (takes **1 min** unless special *cable-siphon tool* used) or by **plugging into a terminal connection** (*Main Action*)

Hack make **INT/Program skill check vs DC**. This takes **10 min** to perform on-the-fly or a *Main Action* if hacker has spent an hour preparing the hack. If rushed, an off-the-cuff hack can be attempted as a *Main Action* against a higher **DC**. Repeated hacking activities become riskier with an additional **+1 to DC** for every attempt within 24 hours

Line Shunts

Long-running hacks as well as ones made against well-guarded and high-security computer systems may require **Line Shunts** (TL4 black-market tech) to be placed at specific locations to spoof normal network state. The correct tapping locations can be determined from a network map or by a successful **Answer a Specific Question** hack. Long-running hacks can run as long as the shunts remain in place (detection depends on nature of location). Corporate systems take **1 shunt**, Government systems take **2 shunts** and Black Sites or TL5 systems take **3 shunts**

Failing a Hack

On failing a hack, hacker must immediately make a second **Hack check vs original DC**. On success, they avoid alarm and location trace. On failure, the system is alerted to the hacker and reports to any overseer. The result of this depends on the nature of the organization under attack

Exploiting the Hack

With a successful hack, a hacker gets what they are after. If it is data, then the data is instantly downloaded. If it is control of an automated system, then control is maintained for **1d4 rounds + Program skill level** before detection and lock out

Common Hacking Actions

Answer a Specific Question retrieve a specific fact or information stored on the system such as specific personal information, virtual and physical locations, locations of security cameras, or other general information to be found

Get General Information pull all available info on a particular topic such as a complete map of location, all security system data, complete personal records, all files for a secret project

Complete Database Acquisition copy an entire database to another computer or storage system or sufficient size. Database must be entirely contained in target system and it takes **1 hour** to decrypt and download (**1 Line Shunt**)

Suppress a System shut down a connected system of like elements such as security cameras, sensors, automated gun turrets. Systems resume as before after hack ends

Subvert a System control a connected system within the devices' normal parameters. Fake data can be used to fool sensors, doors can be opened and weapons fired. A hacker can use their *Main Action* to maintain control each round, otherwise the system simply repeats last state

Sabotage a System completely damage a specific system such that it physically self-destructs or becomes jammed with malignant code. Damage is permanent until repaired. Sabotage always trigger immediate alerts to overseers

Common Hacking Action	DC
Answer a Specific Question	8
Get General Information	10
Complete Database Acquisition	12
Suppress a System	8
Subvert a System	10
Sabotage a System	10

Hacking Circumstances	Mod
Overseers are alarmed	+1
Rushed, unplanned hack	+2
Each hack after first	+1
Especially sensitive system	+1

Types of Systems	Mod
Ordinary personal system	-1
Small business system	+0
Major corp/Minor Government	+1
Mega corp/Major Government	+2